

Du Bois and Alain Locke, whose decisions for their publications were more ____.

- A proficient** skilled
- **B dogmatic** insisting on beliefs without allowing doubt
- C ambiguous** unclear or open to multiple interpretations
- D unpretentious** not claiming importance; plain

Some economic historians ____ that late nineteenth- and early twentieth-century households in the United States experienced an economy of scale when it came to food purchases—they assumed that large households spent less on food per person than did small households.

- **A surmised** concluded from slight evidence
- B contrived** artificially arranged; forced
- C questioned** expressed doubt about
- D regretted** felt sorry about

Charities can mitigate this effect by compensating donors for nuisance costs, but those costs, though variable, are largely ____ donation size, so charities that compensate donors will likely favor attracting a few large donors over many small donors.

- A supplemental to** added to complete
- B predictive of** serving to foretell
- **C independent of** not affected by; separate from
- D subsumed in** absorbed into a larger whole

The results of randomized clinical trials testing the efficacy of common medical interventions sometimes fail to ____ conclusions that practitioners reach based on their real-world observations of patients.

- A circumvent** get around by cleverness
- **B corroborate** confirm or support with evidence
- C disseminate** spread widely
- D implement** put into practice

Businesses typically try to promote themselves, but research by Michael Luca, Abhishek Nagaraj, and Gauri Subramani suggests that some do not ____ their marketing.

- A adorn** decorate or enhance the appearance
- **B optimize** make the most effective possible use of available opportunities
- C endorse** openly approve or recommend
- D counteract** act against so as to cancel

Until recently, Theia was ____, but researcher Qian Yuan and colleagues now claim to have identified pieces of the protoplanet in the lowermost section of Earth's mantle.

- A desultory** aimless; jumping about without plan
- B spurious** false, though appearing genuine
- C veritable** genuine; truly so called
- **D notional** theoretical or only an idea

Before the Mariner 2 mission completed a successful flyby of Venus in 1962, astronomers' ideas about the planet were little more than ____.

- A summations** summaries
- **B conjectures** guesses
- C conclusions** judgments reached by reasoning
- D exemplifications** illustrations by example

*Seminole/Muscogee director Sterlin Harjo ____ television's tendency to situate Native characters in the distant past: this rejection is evident in his series *Reservation Dogs*, which revolves around teenagers who dress in contemporary styles and whose dialogue is laced with current slang.*

- **A repudiates** rejects firmly; disowns
- B proclaims** announces publicly
- C foretells** predicts
- D recants** takes back what was said

Barring major archaeological discoveries, we are unlikely to ever have ____ account of ancient Egypt under the female pharaoh Hatshepsut, as much of the evidence of her reign was deliberately destroyed by her successors.

- A an imaginative** showing invention
- B a superficial** on the surface only; shallow
- **C an exhaustive** thorough and leaving nothing out
- D a questionable** open to doubt

In a study of residential mobility in Washington, DC, LaTanya Brown-Robertson et al. found that increases in household spending power (via tax credits) had mixed effects on mobility decisions, possibly because residential location choices are not fully reducible to economic factors but are also ____ noneconomic factors such as access to strong local social networks.

- A transposed with** swapped places with
- **B mediated by** influenced or affected by something
- C decoupled from** separated or disconnected from
- D antecedent to** coming before

Among stock-market investors, the practice of diversification, or distributing investment funds across many different companies in many different industries, is regarded as ____ since it protects investors from major losses if the value of one particular company or industry sector falls.

- A contentious** causing argument
- **B prudent** careful and sensible
- C unworkable** not able to be made to work
- D optimistic** expecting the best

The creation of Lotte Reiniger's 1926 animated film *The Adventures of Prince Achmed* was ____ process.

- A **a haphazard** without plan or order
- B **a contentious** likely to cause argument
- C **an ineffectual** failing to produce an effect
- D **an arduous** demanding great effort

While tropical species are ____ deep-bodied physical forms (body shapes that are laterally compressed but vertically extended), polar and temperate species are highly dispersed across the morphological spectrum.

- A **authenticated by** proved genuine by
- B **habituated to** grown used to
- C **contemporary with** existing at the same time as
- D **concentrated among** found mostly within

Players use a wooden stick to scrape along ridges cut into the side of the gourd, creating sounds that are highly ____: the sounds produced by *güiros* can differ based on the distance between the ridges, the types of strokes the player uses, and the thickness of the gourd.

- A **overlooked** missed; failed to notice
- B **powerful** having great force or influence
- C **routine** a regular way of doing things
- D **variable** liable to change; not fixed

Proposals to raise the age at which retirees begin receiving government transfers of funds are generally discussed in terms of the effects on transfer recipients, but Andria Smythe has argued that delaying such transfers could ____ wealth creation among working adults by lengthening the period in which they are providing financial support to their nonworking parents.

- A **stymie** block; frustrate the progress of
- B **compound** make greater by adding to
- C **disparage** belittle
- D **outstrip** go faster or further than

In studying the use of external stimuli to reduce the itching sensation caused by an allergic histamine response, Louise Ward and colleagues found that while harmless applications of vibration or warming can provide a temporary distraction, such ____ stimuli actually offer less relief than a stimulus that seems less benign, like a mild electric shock.

- A **deceptive** misleading
- B **innocuous** harmless
- C **novel** new and unlike what came before
- D **impractical** not sensible to do in practice

The fossil remains of the individual known as Oase 1, discovered in Romania in 2002, can help paleoanthropologists not only ____ steps in the evolution of hominids but also illuminate the Pleistocene epoch generally, revealing important details about the time in which Oase 1 lived.

- A **exploit** make full use of; take unfair advantage of
- B **discern** to detect or recognize something, especially something hidden or obscure
- C **prioritize** put first in order of importance
- D **yield** give way; or produce

- A **realized** came to understand; brought about
- B **perceptible** able to be noticed
- C **situated** located
- D **dwindling** steadily shrinking

- A **arguing about** disputing
- B **disapproving of** judging unfavourably
- C **asserting possession of** claiming as one's own
- D **providing resistance to** pushing back against

- A **modesty** not boasting about oneself
- B **misgiving** a feeling of doubt
- C **constraint** repression of one's behavior or actions
- D **composure** calmness under pressure

The subscription model in which consumers who do not deliberately cancel their subscriptions automatically pay recurring fees for access to products and services benefits retailers when consumer ____ is high.

- A **inertia** the tendency to stay as it is
- B **decisiveness** the ability to decide firmly
- C **evasion** avoiding by cleverness
- D **turnover** the rate at which things are replaced

- A **conclude** decide after reasoning
- B **dictate** guide or dominate
- C **evaluate** judge the value or quality of
- D **select** pick out

While recent scholarship has undermined claims that the works of twelfth-century Islamic philosopher Ibn Rushd were ____ other Muslim philosophers of his time, it is indisputable that his location in the Muslim-ruled area of what is now Spain meant that his works were primarily available thousands of miles west of the era's center of Islamic thought.

- A **controversial among** disputed by
- B **antagonistic toward** actively opposed to
- C **imitated by** followed as a model by
- D **inconsequential to** of no significance to

Whether the reign of a French monarch such as Hugh Capet or Henry I was historically consequential or relatively uneventful, its trajectory was shaped by questions of legitimacy and therefore cannot be understood without a corollary understanding of the factors that allowed the monarch to ____ his right to hold the throne.

- A **disengage** detach; withdraw from
- B **annotate** add explanatory notes to
- C **buttress** defend
- D **reciprocate** return in kind

If one has a ____ that the word “get” has a high incidence in English, for example, an analysis of a corpus can support that hypothesis by showing that “get” is the fifth most commonly used verb.

- A **recognition** being identified or acknowledged
- B **scheme** a plan, often a crafty one
- C **supposition** an assumption or hypothesis that is not yet proven
- D **synopsis** a brief outline

Critics have asserted that fine art and fashion rarely ____ in a world where artists create timeless works for exhibition and designers periodically produce new styles for the public to buy.

- A **prevail** win out; be widespread
- B **succumb** give way; yield
- C **diverge** move apart; differ
- D **intersect** cross or overlap

Cannon derives its power in part from the tension among his ____ influences: classic European portraiture, with its realistic treatment of faces; the American pop art movement, with its vivid colors; and flatstyle, the intertribal painting style that rejects the effect of depth typically achieved through shading and perspective.

- A **complementary** completing each other; better together
- B **unknown** not known or identified
- C **disparate** essentially different; not comparable
- D **interchangeable** able to be swapped without difference

Though copies of *The Adventures of Indiana Jones in Wenceslas Square in Prague* on January 16, 1989—an underground computer game that was created anonymously in 1989 as an act of political protest against the authoritarian regime of what was then Czechoslovakia—were originally distributed ____, the game is now readily available online for anyone to play.

- A **succinctly** briefly and clearly
- B **dispassionately** without emotion or bias
- C **disingenuously** insincerely, while pretending honesty
- D **surreptitiously** secretly, to avoid being noticed

Al-Sweedan and Moath Alhaj is inspired by their observation that though there have been many studies of the effect of high altitude on blood chemistry, there is a ____ studies of the effect on blood chemistry of living in locations below sea level, such as the California towns of Salton City and Seeley.

- A **quarrel about** argue angrily over
- B **paucity of** a shortage of
- C **profusion of** a great abundance of
- D **verisimilitude in** the appearance of truth in

Stephen Hannock’s luminous landscape paintings are appealing to viewers but have elicited little commentary from contemporary critics, a phenomenon that may be due to the very fact that the paintings seem so ____.

- A **innovative** introducing new methods
- B **subversive** seeking to undermine
- C **profound** deep; far-reaching
- D **accessible** easy to reach or understand

In a 2021 paper, El Mehdi Sehasseh et al. attribute these artifacts’ apparent ____ to the evolution and propagation of symbolic behavior (e.g., use of personal ornaments) in humans and the widespread availability of T .

- A **heterogeneity** the state of being varied in kind
- B **ubiquity** the state of being everywhere
- C **expediency** what is convenient rather than right
- D **fecundity** fruitfulness; ability to produce much

Containing over 160 billion base pairs of DNA resulting from polyploidy (whole genome duplication) and accumulation of noncoding DNA without significant deletion, the genome of *Tmesipteris oblancheolata* (New Caledonian fork fern) is the largest known among eukaryotes—and, given the high biological costs of extremely large genomes, is unlikely to be ____.

- A **protracted** drawn out over time or space
- B **superseded** surpassed or exceeded by something else
- C **curtailed** cut short or reduced
- D **obviated** made unnecessary or redundant

It is by no means ____ to recognize the influence of Dutch painter Hieronymus Bosch on Ali Banisadr’s paintings; indeed, Banisadr himself cites Bosch as an inspiration.

- A **substantial** considerable in size or importance
- B **satisfying** meeting a need or expectation
- C **unimportant** carrying no weight
- D **appropriate** fitting for the situation

As discussed by scholar Anna Mladentseva, many artworks produced in the mid-1990s to the early 2000s exclusively for exhibition on the internet, such as Sinae Kim's *Genesis* (2001), have become inaccessible because viewing them requires the use of ____ software (most notably Adobe Flash, discontinued in 2021).

- **A defunct** no longer existing or functioning
- B arcane** obscure; known to few
- C ubiquitous** found everywhere
- D extraneous** irrelevant; not belonging

Historians argue that Morris's repudiation of industrialization is ____ the Kelmscott editions' use of handmade materials and intricate ornamentation reminiscent of medieval manuscripts: these meticulously handcrafted elements exemplify the artistry involved.

- A insensible to** unaware of; not feeling
- **B manifest in** evident or apparent from
- C scrutinized by** examined closely by
- D complicated by** made harder by

Scholarly discussions of gender in Shakespeare's comedies often celebrate the rebellion of the playwright's characters against the rigid expectations ____ by Elizabethan society.

- A interjected** cut in with a remark
- B committed** pledged; devoted
- C illustrated** shown by example
- **D prescribed** laid down as a rule

Despite how ____ they may seem on first glance, the works of the philosopher Georg Hegel have proven to be quite influential.

- A authoritative** influential or clearly accurate
- **B opaque** difficult to understand or unclear
- C empirical** based on observation, not theory
- D facile** easy in a shallow way

However, this practice may undercut the applicability of the study's results: people who join a study in response to ____ may differ in important ways from a representative sample of the population of interest.

- A a propensity** a natural tendency
- **B an inducement** something offered to persuade
- C a paradigm** a model or typical pattern
- D an appeasement** a concession made to pacify

Given that the conditions in binary star systems should make planetary formation nearly impossible, it's not surprising that the existence of planets in such systems has lacked ____ explanation.

- A a discernible** able to be noticed
- **B a straightforward** plain and easy to follow
- C an inconclusive** not settling the matter
- D an unbiased** free from prejudice

For her 2021 art installation *Anthem*, Wu Tsang joined forces with singer and composer Beverly Glenn-Copeland to produce a piece that critics found truly ____: they praised Tsang for creatively transforming a museum rotunda into a dynamic exhibit by projecting filmed images of Glenn-Copeland onto a massive 84-foot curtain and filling the space with the sounds of his and other voices singing.

- A restrained** held back; controlled
- **B inventive** good at thinking up new things
- C inexplicable** impossible to explain
- D mystifying** puzzling; hard to explain

Researchers would later ____ this shortcoming after gaining new access to banking records located in nations in Africa, such as Tunisia, and Eastern Europe, such as Hungary.

- A presuppose** assume beforehand
- B categorize** to classify or place into groups
- **C mitigate** to make less severe or reduce the negative effects of something
- D validate** to confirm or substantiate something

The work of Tobias Gerstenberg et al. on tracking eye movements supports a theory that people envision ____ scenarios when making causal judgments: when subjects were asked to look at two colliding billiard balls and judge whether one caused or prevented the other's movement through a gate, their eyes looked at where the target ball would have gone if the ball that altered its path did not exist.

- A ambivalent** having mixed or conflicting feelings
- B retrospective** looking back on the past
- **C counterfactual** contrary to the facts; a what-if
- D analogical** reasoning by comparison

Researcher Haesung Jung led a 2020 study showing that individual acts of kindness can ____ prosocial behavior across a larger group.

- A require** make necessary; demand
- B remember** call back to mind
- **C foster** encourage the growth of
- D discourage** make less willing

In the 2010s, the price of pop music cassette tapes from the 1980s and 1990s rose dramatically, which had the counterintuitive effect of ____ demand: buyers who hadn't previously wanted to purchase vintage cassettes thronged the market, believing prices would continue to rise and the tapes could be resold later at a profit.

- A exploiting** making full use of
- B monetizing** turning into a source of money
- C appraising** assessing the value or significance of something
- **D engendering** producing or causing to exist

Some foraging models predict that the distance bees travel when foraging will decline as floral density increases, but biologists Shalene Jha and Claire Kremen showed that bees' behavior is inconsistent with this prediction if flowers in dense patches are ____: bees will forage beyond patches of low species richness to acquire multiple resource types.

- A depleted** used up; drained
- **B homogeneous** uniform throughout; all of one kind
- C immature** not fully developed
- D dispersed** scattered widely

The migration's obligate nature is why diadromous fish can be ____ those that are merely euryhaline (able to tolerate high salinity): the euryhaline blackchin tilapia can survive high salinity, but its life cycle does not involve relocation to a different biome, as does that of the diadromous wild salmon.

- **A demarcated from** separate or set apart from
- B reconstituted as** put back together as
- C conflated with** wrongly treated as the same as
- D derived from** obtained or developed out of

Some scientists have suggested that mammals in the Mesozoic era were not a very ____ group, but paleontologist Zhe-Xi Luo's research suggests that early mammals living in the shadow of dinosaurs weren't all ground-dwelling insectivores.

- A predatory** preying on others
- B obscure** hard to make out, or little known
- **C diverse** varied; of many kinds
- D localized** confined to one place

In a 2020 paper, Arya Udry et al. cautioned that although similarities in the isotopic signatures of elements detected in Mars's atmosphere and in Martian meteorites recovered on Earth make it tempting to treat the geochemical properties of the meteorites as ____ those of Mars's interiors, Mars's geology cannot be ascertained based solely on meteorite-sample analyses.

- A contrivances of** devices cleverly made up by
- **B proxies for** stand-ins used to measure something else
- C catalysts of** things that trigger
- D deterrents to** things that discourage

While some commentators lauded this development, asserting that such blogs had a welcome transparency missing from traditional news, less ____ observers countered that such blogs tended to ideological extremes that exacerbated political polarization to problematic levels.

- **A sanguine** optimistic
- B recalcitrant** stubbornly refusing to comply
- C misanthropic** disliking people in general
- D earnest** serious and sincere

The familial structure of the black swan (*Cygnus atratus*) shows tremendous ____: breeding pairs with demonstrated success in rearing cygnets (young swans) have been observed to foster those of less successful pairs, and while rearing by female-male pairs is most common, male-male pairs sometimes rear cygnets too, achieving a significantly higher rate of survival to adulthood than female-male pairs.

- A cohesion** holding together as a whole
- **B elasticity** the ability to stretch and return
- C affection** fondness
- D reciprocity** an exchange of like for like

According to a US tax policy expert, state taxes are ____ other factors when considering an interstate move.

- A consistent with** in agreement with
- B representative of** standing as typical of
- **C overshadowed by** made to seem less important by
- D irrelevant to** having no bearing on

But the games are often quite ____ about what data they collect and why.

- **A opaque** not transparent; hard to understand
- B abrasive** harsh; wearing away by rubbing
- C ambivalent** having mixed or conflicting feelings
- D outspoken** frank in saying what one thinks

To demonstrate that the integrity of underground metal pipes can be assessed without unearthing the pipes, engineer Aroba Saleem and colleagues ____ the tendency of some metals' internal magnetic fields to alter under stress: the team showed that such alterations can be measured from a distance and can reveal concentrations of stress in the pipes.

- A hypothesized** made a tentative assumption to be evaluated in a study or experiment
- B discounted** downplayed or ignored
- C redefined** given a new meaning
- **D exploited** made productive use

Detailed statistical analysis helped preclude claims of the event's ____, confirming the signal at a confidence level of over 99%.

- A inconspicuousness** the quality of being unnoticeable or difficult to detect
- B discretion** good judgment about what to say
- **C ambiguity** uncertainty or doubtfulness
- D probability** likelihood

The author's claim about the relationship between Neanderthals and Homo sapiens is ____, as it fails to account for several recent archaeological discoveries.

- A disorienting** causing loss of bearings
- **B tenuous** thin and weak; barely holding
- C nuanced** alert to fine distinctions
- D unoriginal** copied; not new

Given the formation's greater prevalence among whales known to make deeper dives, some researchers hypothesize that its role isn't ____; rather, the accessory spleen may actively support diving mechanisms.

- A replicable** able to be reproduced
- B predetermined** settled in advance
- C operative** in force; working
- **D latent** present but not yet showing

Because Xoconochco's location within the empire was so ____, cacao and other trade goods produced there could reach the capital only after a long overland journey.

- A unobtrusive** not drawing attention
- B concealed** hidden
- C approximate** close but not exact
- **D peripheral** at the edge; not central

Preceding a flare, the corona temporarily exhibits increased brightness above the region where the flare is ____.

- A antecedent** something that comes before
- **B impending** imminent or approaching
- C innocuous** harmless
- D perpetual** never ending

A casual description of Scherezade García's 2019 mural Blame It on the Bean: The Power of Coffee can make the work seem ____—a painting that is housed in a coffee shop and that depicts three women drinking coffee may not sound particularly ambitious—but in fact the work is a complex, dynamic meditation on gender and the legacy of colonialism that demands serious attention.

- **A unassuming** modest; not drawing attention
- B shrewd** sharp in practical judgment
- C incongruous** out of keeping; not fitting together
- D pretentious** claiming more importance than is due

Chen contributed to a groundbreaking study challenging the accepted view that among prehistoric peoples, female participation in hunting was ____.

- A inevitable** certain to happen; unavoidable
- B satisfactory** good enough to meet the standard
- **C negligible** too small to matter
- D commonplace** ordinary; met with everywhere